

particular software or hardware. If the BSOD repeats with the same message, then there is potentially something seriously wrong, and you should investigate further.

1.6.2 The basic approach

Use the file name in the error message to give you a clue as to what is causing the problem. Search the hard disk for the filename and look at the folder in which the file is located to give you an idea of which software program or hardware uses this file. Also search the Internet for any information on this file. Once you have identified the software or hardware associated with the filename, uninstall or remove the software or hardware. Verify that the software or hardware, as the case may be, is compatible with your version of Windows. Get updates if applicable and reinstall it. Also, see the Troubleshooting Startup, Shutdown and Power Management sections in this guide.

1.6.2.1 System Restore in Windows ME and Windows XP

In addition to the above, Windows ME/XP provides the extremely useful System Restore tool. System Restore takes daily snapshots of the system state—every 10 hours the system is on and every 24 hours of real-time. The snapshot contains all the information required to restore the system to that particular point in time. To restore the system to a previous point in time do the following:

- Go to Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > System Restore.
- Choose “Restore my computer to an earlier time” and click Next.
- On the calendar on the left, choose the last day you remember that Windows operated without problems. On the right, choose the Restore Point description; if there are multiple restore points that day, choose the one you’re most certain about or choose the latest time. Click Next.
- Make sure you’ve closed all open files and running programs, and click OK.
- The system will roll back to the settings of that restore point and you can continue working normally.

1.6.2.2 Windows 2000/XP

Error reporting in Windows 2000/XP is more robust, nevertheless,